

FILTER DESIGN TEST CASE

Ladder Filter - Band 3 (1800 MHz) for Millimeter-Wave Beamforming
Design Validation and Performance Characterization

DOCUMENT INFORMATION

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Author:	Dr. Elena Vasquez
Reviewer:	Dr. Pierre Dubois
Design Center:	Helsinki 5G Lab
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1. OBJECTIVE

This document describes the design, simulation, and characterization of a Ladder Filter filter targeting Band 3 (1800 MHz) for Millimeter-Wave Beamforming. The filter is designed on Quartz substrate with a target center frequency of 4232.0 MHz and bandwidth of 152.0 MHz. The objective is to validate that the filter meets the required insertion loss, rejection, and linearity specifications for integration into the Millimeter-Wave Beamforming module. This design iteration addresses feedback from the previous revision regarding out-of-band rejection improvements and temperature stability.

2. SCOPE

- Filter Type: Ladder Filter
- Frequency Band: Band 3 (1800 MHz)
- Application: Millimeter-Wave Beamforming
- Substrate: Quartz
- Package: WLP (Wafer Level Package)
- Design Tool: Sonnet EM Suite v16
- Design Center: Helsinki 5G Lab

This specification applies to all variants of the Ladder Filter design targeting Band 3 (1800 MHz). Results are used to qualify the design for mass production release.

3. DESIGN PARAMETERS

Center Frequency:	4232.0 MHz
Bandwidth (3 dB):	152.0 MHz
Insertion Loss Target:	≤ 2.0 dB
Return Loss Target:	≥ 18.0 dB
Out-of-Band Rejection:	≥ 42.0 dB
Isolation (Duplexer):	≥ 37.0 dB
Q Factor:	1817
Temperature Coefficient:	-29.7 ppm/°C
Die Size:	0.8 x 1.3 mm
Wafer Size:	6-inch
Number of Resonators:	11
Electrode Material:	Pt/Al

Passivation: SiO2

4. TEST PROCEDURE

1. Open Sonnet EM Suite v16 and load the Ladder Filter template project.
2. Define the substrate stack: Quartz with specified layer thicknesses.
3. Set design targets: center freq 4232.0 MHz, BW 152.0 MHz.
4. Run initial EM simulation with 2D mesh density of 20 cells/wavelength.
5. Optimize resonator geometry using gradient descent (target IL < 2.0 dB).
6. Verify coupling coefficients between resonator stages.
7. Run 3D FEM simulation to account for package parasitics (WLP (Wafer Level Package)).
8. Export GDS-II layout for mask fabrication.
9. Fabricate prototype wafers (6-inch, Quartz).
10. Perform on-wafer probing using Keysight N9041B UXA.
11. Measure S-parameters (S11, S21, S12, S22) from 100 MHz to 12696 MHz.
12. Compare measured results against simulation and specification limits.
13. Perform temperature cycling (-40°C to +85°C) and re-measure.
14. Document results and generate summary report.

5. ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Insertion loss at center frequency shall be <= 2.0 dB
- Return loss in passband shall be >= 18.0 dB
- Out-of-band rejection at +/- 228 MHz offset >= 42.0 dB
- Group delay variation across passband shall be <= 8 ns
- Temperature drift over -40°C to +85°C shall be <= 15.7 MHz
- Power handling shall be >= +28 dBm at 1 dB compression
- ESD tolerance >= 1000 V (HBM)
- Die yield on qualification lot >= 90%

6. TEST RESULTS

Measurement Date: 2024-12-07
Devices Tested: 19
Insertion Loss (meas): 1.68 dB
Return Loss (meas): 20.3 dB
Rejection (meas): 45.1 dB
Isolation (meas): 42.1 dB
Q Factor (meas): 1817
Group Delay Variation: 1.5 ns
Power Handling: +28 dBm
Die Yield: 89.3%

Result Classification: CONDITIONAL PASS

7. OBSERVATIONS AND FINDINGS

- a) The Ladder Filter design demonstrated acceptable performance for Band 3 (1800 MHz).
- b) Insertion loss met target specification.
- c) Out-of-band rejection exceeded the minimum requirement.
- d) Simulation-to-measurement correlation was within 3% for all key parameters.
- e) ESD robustness exceeded specification by 2x margin.

8. CORRECTIVE ACTIONS

- 1. Review near-band rejection margin for worst-case temperature.
- 2. Re-run EM simulation with refined mesh for better accuracy.
- 3. Schedule follow-up measurement after design tweak.

9. SIGN-OFF

Author:	Dr. Elena Vasquez	Date:	2024-12-07
Reviewer:	Dr. Pierre Dubois	Date:	2024-12-12
Approver:	Dr. Yuko Ishida	Date:	2024-12-14

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